ASCNDLABS PRODUCT GUIDE

AI Program Launcher

A detailed guide to website-based program generation, review, draft saving, publishing, visibility, guardrails, and troubleshooting.

One-sentence outcome

Enter a public business website, receive an editable affiliate-program draft, approve the content, and publish it into the account's existing affiliate program.

Area	Current behavior
Entry point	Sidebar -> AI Program Launcher
AI provider	GroqCloud, called only from the server
Configured model	The model named by GROQ_MODEL in server/.env
Publication model	Owner review and explicit Publish program action
Visibility after publish	Program Settings -> Published program kit
Generation limit	5 generations or section regenerations per account per day

Important: Publishing activates and saves the approved program. It does not automatically recruit affiliates, send messages, create a public landing page, or initiate payouts.

1. What the AI Program Launcher does

The launcher reduces the work required to configure an affiliate program. It reads a small amount of public product context, asks GroqCloud for a structured recommendation, validates every field, and presents the result as an editable review.

The workflow

- **Collect context.** The owner enters a website URL, optional product description, preferred commission model, average order value, and notes.
- **Read public pages.** The server reads the homepage and up to three relevant same-domain pages such as pricing, features, products, services, FAQ, or about.
- **Generate structured content.** GroqCloud returns JSON for the required program fields.
- **Validate.** The server requires every text section, clamps commission to 0-100, and clamps cookie duration to 1-365 days.
- **Review.** The owner can edit the result or regenerate an individual section.
- **Save or publish.** Save Draft preserves work without changing the live program. Publish copies the approved fields into the existing affiliate program and makes it active.

No automatic publication	Generation itself never changes the live affiliate program. The owner must press Publish program after reviewing the result.

Inputs

Input	Required?	Purpose
Website URL	Yes	Primary public context for the offer and brand.
Product description	Optional	Fallback when the site blocks extraction or contains very little readable text. Use at least 40 characters for fallback.
Commission model	Yes	Percentage, flat-fee preference, or recommend for me. The current live program still stores a percentage rate.
Average order value	Optional	Helps the model recommend a commercially sensible percentage.
Notes	Optional	Brand tone, partner restrictions, or other owner guidance.

2. What the generated draft contains

Every generated item is displayed separately so the owner can understand, edit, save, or regenerate it without replacing unrelated approved work.

Field	Meaning	Publication destination
Program name	The name affiliates will recognize.	affiliateProgram.name
Commission rate	Recommended percentage from 0 to 100.	affiliateProgram.commissionRate
Cookie duration	Attribution window from 1 to 365 days.	affiliateProgram.cookieDays
Program description	Public explanation of the offer and intended customer.	affiliateProgram.programDescription
Ideal affiliate profile	Partner traits and audiences most likely to fit.	affiliateProgram.idealAffiliateProfile
Invitation message	Reusable recruitment email or direct message.	affiliateProgram.invitationMessage
Terms summary	Plain-language commercial summary requiring owner review.	affiliateProgram.termsSummary
FAQ	Common questions and concise answers.	affiliateProgram.faq
Promotional angles	Campaign ideas affiliates can adapt.	affiliateProgram.contentAngles

Regeneration behavior

- New name regenerates only the program name.
- New commission regenerates the rate and its recommendation reason.
- New cookie regenerates the duration and its recommendation reason.
- Every other Regenerate section action replaces only that visible section.
- Before regeneration, current manual edits are saved so unrelated sections remain intact.

Version history Each full generation or section regeneration increments the saved draft version and updates generatedAt. The product currently retains the latest raw and edited versions, not an unlimited historical archive.

3. What Publish program does

Direct answer	Publish validates the current edited draft, writes the approved fields into the signed-in account's existing affiliateProgram object, changes its status to active, and marks the launcher draft as published.

Exact effects

- Validates the program name, required text, FAQ, promotional angles, commission rate, and cookie duration on the server.
- Preserves the original program createdAt date when editing an existing program.
- Writes the approved core terms and content kit to the existing single-program object.
- Sets affiliateProgram.status to active.
- Marks programLauncherDraft.status as published.
- Invalidates the client program queries so refreshed screens load the approved values.
- Shows a published confirmation and buttons for View published program and Invite affiliates.

Where the result appears

Location	What appears
Program Settings	Core terms plus the complete Published program kit: description, audience, invitation, terms, FAQ, and promotional angles.
Invite & Affiliates	The existing invitation workflow and referral link continue to use the published program commission terms.
AI Program Launcher	The last generated/edited version remains available, marked Published, for later review or regeneration.

What publishing does not do

- It does not create a separate company, workspace, or second affiliate program.
- It does not create a public affiliate-program landing page.
- It does not email or message prospective affiliates.
- It does not automatically approve applicants or referrals.
- It does not create earnings, move money, connect Stripe, or request a payout.
- It does not make generated legal text authoritative; the owner must review commercial and legal terms.

Why it previously looked like nothing happened	The server saved the generated content, but only the basic program fields were visible on existing screens. Program Settings now includes a dedicated Published program kit so the saved result is visible immediately.

4. Save Draft versus Publish Program

Behavior	Save Draft	Publish Program
Stores manual edits	Yes	Yes
Changes live core settings	No	Yes
Activates the program	No	Yes
Updates invitation terms	No	Yes
Shows Published program kit	No	Yes
Can be edited later	Yes	Yes
Requires server validation	Yes	Yes

Recommended owner workflow

- Generate the first draft from the website.
- Check the commission recommendation against unit economics and refund risk.
- Review cookie duration against the normal buying cycle.
- Remove any statement the business cannot substantiate.
- Edit the invitation message to sound like the business.
- Review the terms summary with the appropriate legal or commercial owner.
- Save Draft if review is incomplete.
- Publish only when the program is ready to invite affiliates.
- Open Program Settings and confirm the Published program kit.
- Open Invite & Affiliates and copy the live invitation link.

5. Safety, validation, and account isolation

The launcher is implemented as a server-side feature inside the existing authenticated referral workflow. Browser code never receives the GroqCloud key.

Guardrail	Implementation
Authentication	Every launcher endpoint runs after verifyToken and uses req.user._id.
Account isolation	The client cannot supply another account ID for reading or publishing.
Provider key	GROQ_API_KEY is read only by the server.
Website safety	Only HTTP/HTTPS public sites are accepted. Localhost, credentials in URLs, private IP ranges, and local/internal hostnames are rejected.
Redirect safety	Redirect targets are revalidated and capped at three.
Fetch limits	10-second page timeout and 700 KB maximum per page.
Extraction scope	Homepage plus up to three relevant same-domain pages.
Prompt safety	Website text is treated as untrusted source material and instructions inside it are ignored.
Output validation	JSON is parsed and every field is validated again by application code and Mongoose.
Unsupported claims	High-risk guarantee language is rejected rather than silently published.
Usage limit	Five full generations or section regenerations per account per 24 hours.
Publication	Only an explicit owner action copies reviewed fields to the live program.

6. Technical architecture

Request sequence

- Client posts business context to POST /api/referral/program/launcher/generate.
- The authenticated server validates the input and safely extracts public pages.
- The server calls GroqCloud Chat Completions using GROQ_MODEL.
- Groq returns JSON-object output; the server validates and normalizes it.
- Raw generated content and edited content are stored separately in programLauncherDraft.
- The client displays the saved draft and lets the owner edit or regenerate sections.
- PUT /api/referral/program/launcher/draft saves manual edits only.
- POST /api/referral/program/launcher/publish copies approved content to affiliateProgram.

Launcher endpoints

Method and path	Purpose
GET /api/referral/program/launcher	Load the signed-in account's latest draft.
POST /api/referral/program/launcher/generate	Extract context and create a complete new draft.
POST /api/referral/program/launcher/regenerate	Regenerate one approved section name.
PUT /api/referral/program/launcher/draft	Validate and persist manual edits without publishing.
POST /api/referral/program/launcher/publish	Validate and publish the edited draft into affiliateProgram.

Persisted draft separation

- **rawGenerated** preserves the latest AI-generated form of each section.
- **editedContent** preserves the owner's manual version.
- **sourceUrls** records pages successfully read during generation.
- **generatedAt, version, model, and status** provide operational context.

7. Troubleshooting

Message or symptom	Meaning	Resolution
Could not read enough public website content	The site returned very little readable HTML, is heavily client-rendered, or blocked the reader.	Add a product description of at least 40 characters and retry. The launcher will use it as fallback context.
Private or local websites cannot be scanned	The URL resolved to localhost, a private IP, or a local/internal hostname.	Use a publicly reachable HTTPS website. Do not expose internal services merely to bypass this protection.
Website took too long to respond	The page exceeded the server extraction timeout.	Retry once, use a faster public page, or provide a product description fallback.
Daily AI Program Launcher limit reached	Five generation actions were used in the current 24-hour window.	Continue manual editing and Save Draft, or retry after the limit resets.
Draft saved but program unchanged	Save Draft intentionally does not alter the live program.	Press Publish program after review.
Published but no affiliates appear	Publishing configures the program; it does not recruit affiliates.	Open Invite & Affiliates, copy the link or invitation, and share it.
Generated content is not suitable	The model lacked context or the business requires narrower rules.	Improve product description and notes, edit manually, or regenerate only the affected section.

Verification checklist

- Program Settings shows the Published program badge.
- Program name, commission rate, and cookie duration match the reviewed draft.
- The Published program kit displays description, audience, invitation, terms, FAQ, and promotional angles.
- Invite & Affiliates provides a working referral link.
- The launcher still displays the published version after refresh.
- No generated text contains an unsupported promise or unreviewed commercial term.

8. Product boundaries and recommended next steps

The current launcher is a narrow onboarding assistant. It intentionally prepares and publishes program configuration, not a complete public partner portal.

Current boundary	The generated content is an internal owner-facing program kit shown in Program Settings. Affiliates receive the existing referral link and invitation workflow. A public hosted program page would be a separate feature.

Reasonable future enhancements

- Optional public affiliate-program landing page built from approved fields.
- Copy buttons for each published kit section.
- A controlled Send Invitation workflow with templates and delivery logs.
- Draft history and restore by version.
- Per-plan usage quotas and usage reporting.
- More robust browser rendering for websites that require JavaScript.

Do not assume these actions

- Do not assume Publish sends email, posts content, or creates affiliate accounts.
- Do not assume AI recommendations replace financial, tax, or legal review.
- Do not assume a higher commission automatically improves program performance.
- Do not assume website extraction proves every statement on the site is current or accurate.

Final takeaway: Generate creates a reviewable draft. Save Draft preserves work. Publish validates and activates the approved program. Program Settings is the source of truth for the published program kit, while Invite & Affiliates is the next operational step.